WHAT ARE FORMULAS IN EXCEL, AND WHAT ARE THEIR PURPOSES?

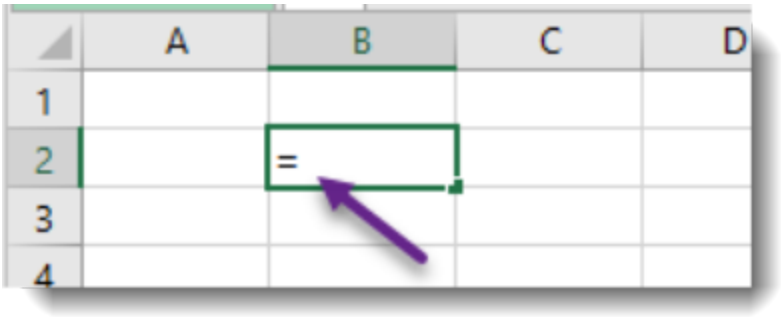
Formulas are an integral part of using Excel effectively in your work. The term formula is used in Excel to describe a set of instructions used to instruct Excel to calculate or retrieve data from a worksheet.

An Excel formula automates calculations and simplifies working with data in a worksheet.

Excel's equations use the following standard operators;

- Plus sign + for addition = 7 + 5
- Minus sign - for subtraction = 10 - 5
- Asterisk * for multiplication = 10 * 5
- Forward slash / for division = 10 / 5
- Caret ^ for exponents. = 10^2

Note that formulas in Excel are entered into cells and come first by typing an equal sign (=).



A formula can include cell references, functions, and mathematical and logical operators.